

Icarus Mod Manager

Setup Guide

A beginner-friendly walkthrough — install once, mod forever

This guide gets you from **"I just heard about modding Icarus"** to **"I've installed the Mod Manager and it's ready to use"**. No technical experience required — we'll go one step at a time and explain what each click does.

What is the Icarus Mod Manager?

JimK72's Icarus Mod Manager (we'll call it **IMM** for short) is a free Windows app that lets you install, manage, and merge mods for the game Icarus. Think of it as a control panel for your mods — drag mods in, click a button, and IMM does the heavy lifting of preparing them for the game.

What you need before starting

- A Windows PC.
- Icarus installed (Steam or Epic).
- About 10 minutes for the setup.
- An unzipping tool (Windows 11 has it built in; Windows 10 needs 7-Zip or WinRAR).

■ **TIP:** You don't need to be a programmer. If you can drag a folder around, you can do this.

Part 1 — Download and Extract IMM

Step 1 — Download the Mod Manager

Open this link in your browser:

https://github.com/Jimk72/Icarus_Software

On that page, look on the right-hand side for the "**Releases**" section. Click the latest release (the top one). On the release page, scroll to "**Assets**" and download the file that ends in **.zip** — usually called something like **IcarusModManager.zip**.

■ **TIP:** Newer versions of IMM (2.2+) include UnrealPak inside the zip, so you don't need to download it separately. If you see a separate UnrealPak.zip on the release page, grab it too — your antivirus may have removed the included copy.

Step 2 — Pick a safe folder for IMM

You're going to extract the zip somewhere on your computer. **Pick the location carefully:**

■ **Good places:** A new folder on your Desktop, in your Documents, or directly on a drive like **D:\Mods**.

■ **Avoid:** **C:\Program Files**, **C:\Program Files (x86)**, or anywhere inside **Windows**. Those folders need admin permission and IMM will have problems writing files there.

Step 3 — Extract the zip

Right-click the downloaded **IcarusModManager.zip** file and choose "**Extract All...**" (Windows built-in) or use 7-Zip / WinRAR. Pick the safe folder you chose in Step 2 as the destination.

After extracting, open the new folder. You should see files like **IcarusModManager.exe** and **UnrealPak.exe** (and others).

■■ **WATCH OUT:** If your antivirus quarantined **UnrealPak.exe**, that's a known false positive. Restore it from quarantine and add the IMM folder to your antivirus exclusions, or download UnrealPak.zip separately from the same Releases page and drop UnrealPak.exe into the IMM folder yourself.

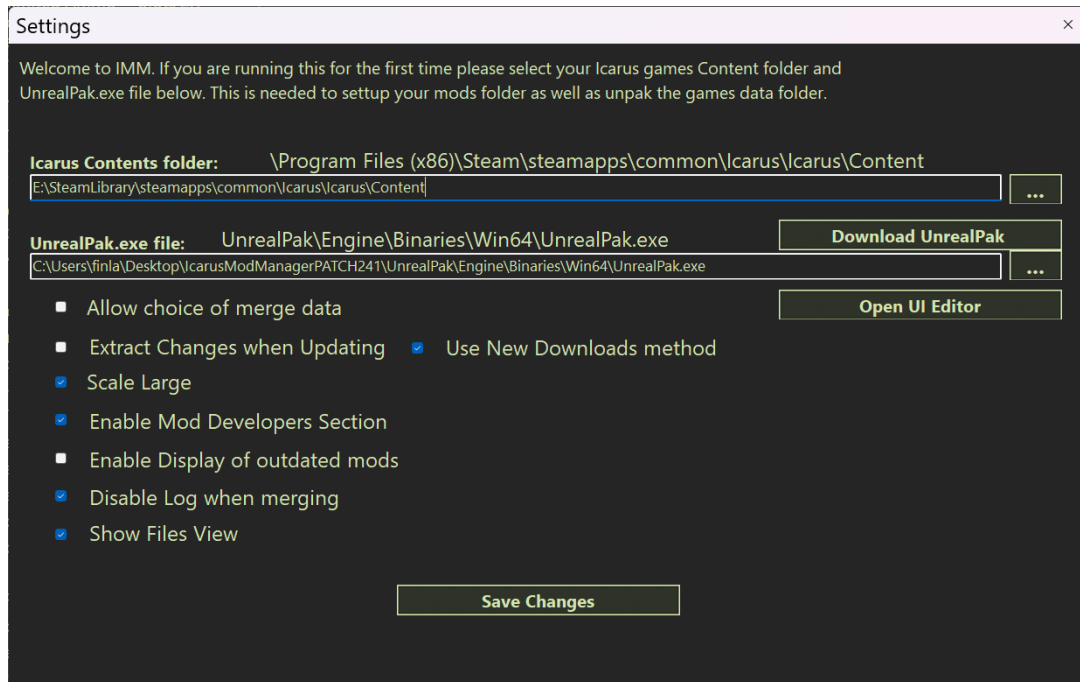
Part 2 — First Launch and Settings

Step 4 — Launch IMM

Double-click **IcarusModManager.exe**. The first time you launch, IMM will show a popup asking you to configure settings, and you may see a "file not found" message. **This is normal** — IMM is just looking for game data that you haven't pointed it at yet. We'll fix that next.

Step 5 — Open Settings

In the IMM window, click the **Settings** button on the right side of the main window (or use **Edit** → **Settings** at the top). The Settings window opens and looks like this:



On first run you'll see the welcome text at the top: *"Welcome to IMM. If you are running this for the first time please select your Icarus games Content folder and UnrealPak.exe file below."* That's exactly what we're about to do.

Step 6 — Set the Icarus Content folder

IMM needs to know where Icarus is installed so it can read game data and install mods. In Settings, find the **"Icarus Content folder"** (or similar) field and click the browse button next to it.

Navigate to your Icarus install folder. The exact path depends on where you installed it:

Steam: usually somewhere like

[Drive]:\SteamLibrary\steamapps\common\Icarus\Icarus\Content

Epic:

[Drive]:\Epic Games\Icarus\Icarus\Content

■ **TIP:** Don't pick the outer Icarus folder — go one level deeper to **...\\Icarus\\Content**. If you can't find it, in Steam right-click Icarus → Manage → Browse local files. From there, open the **Icarus** subfolder, then the **Content** subfolder, and use that path.

Step 7 — Set the UnrealPak path

Still in Settings, find the "**UnrealPak.exe file:**" field. Click the ... browse button on the right and navigate to the IMM folder you extracted in Step 3 — pick **UnrealPak.exe** from there. The path will end with something like:

UnrealPak\Engine\Binaries\Win64\UnrealPak.exe

UnrealPak is the tool IMM uses to package and unpackage Icarus mod files. Without it, merging won't work.

■ **TIP: Don't have UnrealPak.exe?** No need to hunt for it — click the **Download UnrealPak** button on the right of the Settings window. IMM will fetch a fresh copy and save it for you. Use this if your antivirus quarantined it, or if your release zip didn't include it.

Step 8 — Save and close Settings

Click **Save Changes** at the bottom of the Settings window. The window may close on its own, or you can close it manually.

The other checkboxes in Settings (Scale Large, Show Files View, etc.) are personal preferences — the defaults are fine for most users. You can revisit them later.

■■ **WATCH OUT: Now exit IMM completely and restart it.** This is critical — IMM only loads your settings on a fresh launch. If you skip the restart, the next steps may fail with confusing errors.

Part 3 — First Run After Settings

Step 9 — Re-launch IMM

Double-click **IcarusModManager.exe** again. This time it will load with your settings active.

Step 10 — Update the data folder

On first proper launch, IMM may pop up saying your **data folder is outdated** (or missing). Click **OK / Yes**. IMM will unpack Icarus's data tables so it can edit them when you install mods. This takes a minute or two — let it finish.

If no popup appears, find the **"Update data Folder"** button on the right side of the main IMM window and click it once.

■ **TIP:** Re-run **Update data Folder** after every Icarus game update. The Mod Manager needs the latest game data to merge mods correctly. If you skip this step after a patch, mods may behave oddly or fail to merge.

Step 11 — Verify the mods folder exists

Click the **Open Icarus Mod Folder** button on the right side of IMM. Windows Explorer should open to a folder like:

```
[Drive]:\SteamLibrary\steamapps\common\Icarus\Icarus\Content\Paks\mods
```

If Explorer says the folder doesn't exist, navigate to **...Paks** and create a new folder named exactly **mods** (lowercase). This is where IMM will save the merged mod files when you install mods.

Step 12 — You're ready!

Setup is done. From here you can:

- Click **Download Mods** on the right to browse mods directly from inside IMM.
- Click **Import EXMODZ File** to bring in a mod you already downloaded as **.EXMODZ**.
- Click **Extract Mod from PAK File** to import a mod that came as a **.pak** file.

Part 4 — Common Setup Issues

"IMM won't open / crashes immediately"

- Make sure you extracted the **full** contents of the zip — sometimes Windows opens the zip without actually extracting, and the .exe runs against missing files.
- Check that **UnrealPak.exe** sits next to **IcarusModManager.exe** in the same folder.
- Try running IMM as administrator (right-click → Run as administrator) once, just to rule out permission problems.

"Antivirus deleted UnrealPak.exe"

This is a known false positive. UnrealPak is a packaging tool from Epic's Unreal Engine — it's safe. To fix:

1. Open your antivirus quarantine, find UnrealPak.exe, and restore it.
2. Add the entire IMM folder to your antivirus exclusions so it doesn't get quarantined again.
3. If the file is fully gone, the easiest fix is to open **Settings** in IMM and click the **Download UnrealPak** button — IMM grabs a fresh copy and saves it for you. Or download **UnrealPak.zip** manually from the GitHub releases page and drop the .exe back into your IMM folder.

"It can't find the data folder"

- Confirm the path you set in Settings ends in **...Icarus\Content** (note: the path has **Icarus** twice — outer install folder, then inner game folder, then **Content**).
- Make sure you launched Icarus at least once after installing it. Steam/Epic only finishes some setup on first launch.
- Click **Update data Folder** manually to force the unpack.

"Settings don't seem to take effect"

You probably skipped the restart. Close IMM completely (check the system tray for any leftover IMM icon and exit there too), then re-launch.

"My Icarus install is on a different drive than usual"

No problem — IMM works on any drive. Just point Settings at the right path. The easiest way to find it: in Steam, right-click Icarus → Manage → Browse local files. That opens Explorer at the install root, and you can copy the path from the address bar.

Part 5 — Quick reference

Setup checklist (copy this!)

- Downloaded IcarusModManager.zip from github.com/Jimk72/Icarus_Software
- Extracted to a safe folder (NOT Program Files)
- Launched IMM once
- Edit → Settings → set Icarus Content folder
- Edit → Settings → set UnrealPak.exe path
- Saved settings
- **Closed and re-launched IMM**
- Clicked "Update data Folder" (or accepted the popup)
- Confirmed Paks/mods folder exists (clicked "Open Icarus Mod Folder")
- Ready to import or download mods

Important paths

IMM install folder (your choice — example):

D:\Mods\IcarusModManager\

Icarus Content folder (Steam example):

[Drive]:\SteamLibrary\steamapps\common\Icarus\Icarus\Content

Mods get installed to:

[Drive]:\SteamLibrary\steamapps\common\Icarus\Icarus\Content\Paks\mods\

After every Icarus update

When the game updates (weekly patch, expansion, etc.), the data files IMM uses need to refresh too. The good news: **IMM does this automatically most of the time.**

When you launch IMM after an Icarus patch, it detects the new game version and attempts to update the data folder on its own. You'll see a popup or progress message — let it finish before doing anything else.

If the auto-update fails (you see an error, the data looks stale, or merges start behaving oddly), run it manually:

1. Launch IMM.
2. Click **Update data Folder** on the right side. Wait for it to finish.
3. Now you can re-merge and install your mods normally.

Skipping the data update (when needed) can cause merges to fail or mods to behave incorrectly in-game.

Your weekly workflow (the short version)

You don't need to remove and re-download all your mods every week. **If your mod list hasn't changed**, the recurring flow is just three clicks:

1. Launch IMM and let it auto-update the data folder (or click **Update data Folder** manually if needed).
2. Click **Reload Last merged List** on the right side — this brings back your saved set of mods.
3. Click **Install All Listed Mods** at the top of the Mods to Install column to re-merge.
4. Launch the game.

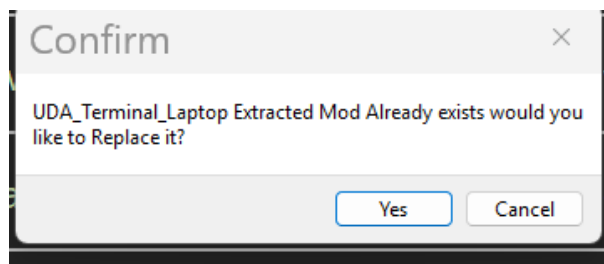
■ **TIP:** You only need to re-download or re-import a mod when **that specific mod** has been updated by its author (new version on GitHub/Nexus/Discord). Vanilla Icarus patches alone don't require re-downloading mods — just refresh the data folder and re-merge.

When you DO need to re-download a mod

Re-grab a specific mod when:

- The mod author releases a new version (check their release notes or the modder's Discord).
- That one mod broke after the latest patch and others kept working.
- You see a "version mismatch" or "row not found" error tied to that mod.

Updating a single mod is easy — you don't need to manually delete the old one first. Just import the new **.EXMODZ** the normal way (or download it from the Mod Downloads window). IMM detects you already have that mod and pops up a confirmation dialog like this:

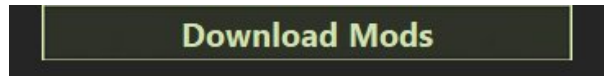


Click **Yes** and IMM replaces the old version with the new one in your Extracted Mods list. Then run the standard 3-click weekly merge above to bake the update into your merged mod file.

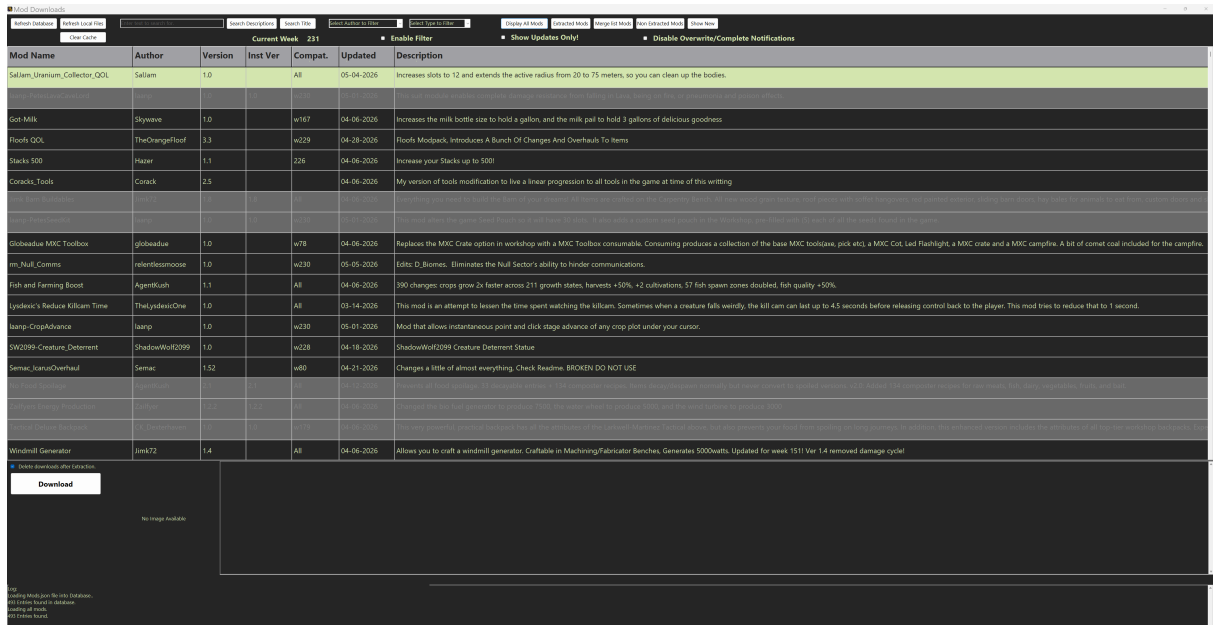
■ **TIP:** Only use the manual delete + re-import path if something's gone wrong (corrupted import, mod renamed by author, etc.). For normal version bumps, the **Yes / Replace** popup handles everything for you.

Part 6 — The Mod Downloads window

IMM has a built-in browser for finding, downloading, and updating mods — you don't have to hunt around GitHub or Discord for files. Click the **Download Mods** button on the right side of the main IMM window:



This opens a **separate window** called *Mod Downloads*:

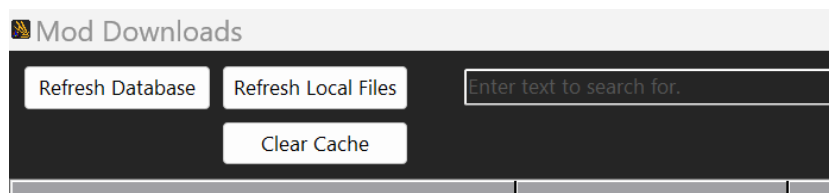


It pulls its mod list from projectdaedalus.app/info, which refreshes on a **4-hour interval**. So if a mod author publishes a new version, expect it to show up here within four hours.

■ **TIP: Can't see the Mod Downloads window?** It often opens minimised or hides behind your main IMM window. Check your taskbar in the corner for a small icon like this:



Top-left buttons: refresh and cache

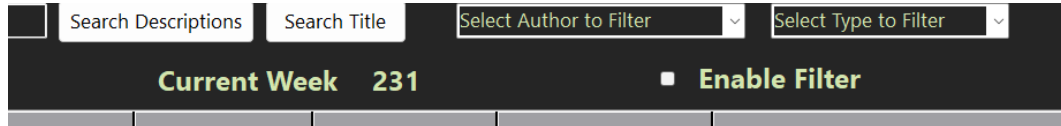


Refresh Database — re-fetches the latest mod list from projectdaedalus.app and makes it available inside IMM. Click this when you want to see what's new since the last time you opened the window.

Refresh Local Files — goes through every mod in the list and downloads its icon and metadata to your computer. **Not essential** — it just makes browsing prettier. Skip it if you're in a hurry.

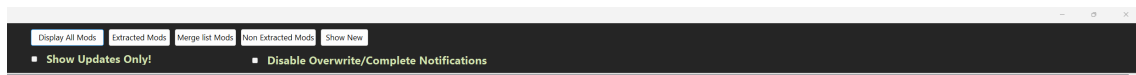
Clear Cache — wipes the local cached icons and metadata. Useful if downloads are misbehaving or you want a fresh start. Won't delete any installed mods.

Centre row: search, filters, current week



- **Search Descriptions / Search Title** — type in the search box and click one of these to filter by what's in a mod's name vs. its description.
- **Select Author to Filter / Select Type to Filter** — narrow by mod author or by mod type (PAK / EXMODZ / etc.).
- **Current Week** shows which Icarus week the mod database is matched against — useful for spotting if a mod's "Compat." column is older than the current game version.
- **Enable Filter** checkbox — turn the active filter on/off without losing your selection.

Top-right buttons: filtering the list



Display All Mods — show every mod in the database, no filters applied. The default starting view.

Extracted Mods — filter to only mods you've already imported into IMM (the ones in your Extracted Mods list).

Merge list Mods — filter to only mods currently queued in your Mods to Install column.

Non Extracted Mods — filter to only mods you *haven't* imported yet. Useful for discovering what else is available.

Show New — filter to recently-added mods (newly published by modders). Good for discovering fresh content.

Below the buttons are two checkboxes:

- **Show Updates Only!** — filter the list to only mods you already have installed that have a newer version available. This is the button you want when checking your weekly upkeep.
- **Disable Overwrite/Complete Notifications** — silences the popups that confirm each download. Helpful if you're downloading a lot of mods at once.

■ **TIP: Mod won't leave the Show Updates Only list?** If a mod still shows as needing an update *after* you've downloaded the latest version, the mod author messed up the version info inside the mod files. The download itself is fine — you got the latest version — but the listing won't clear until the author fixes their version metadata and republishes. You can ignore the listing in the meantime; nothing else needs doing on your end.

■ **TIP: Weekly check-in shortcut:** open Mod Downloads → click **Refresh Database** → tick **Show Updates Only!**. If the list is empty, you're fully up to date and can run the 3-click merge from earlier. If there are entries, download them — IMM will pop up a **Replace** confirmation for each, click **Yes**, then run the merge.

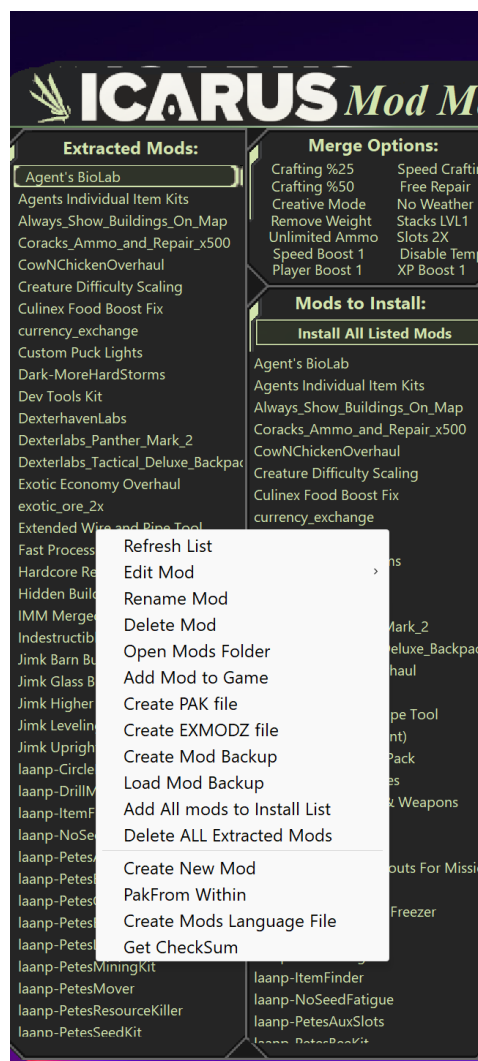
Other things to know about this window

- The **Compat.** column shows the latest week the mod author tested against. "All" means no specific lock; a number like "w229" means tested against that week.
- The **Updated** column shows when the mod was last published.
- The **Inst Ver** column shows your installed version (blank if you haven't imported it).
- **Delete downloads after Extraction** (checkbox at bottom-left of the window) — leave it ticked to save disk space; uncheck if you want to keep the raw download archives.

Where to go next

Now that IMM is set up, the full first-time mod-install flow is:

1. Download or import the mods you want — they appear in **Extracted Mods**.
2. Right-click the Extracted Mods list and pick **"Add All mods to Install List"** (or add specific mods one at a time). The right-click menu looks like this:



3. Click **Install All Listed Mods** at the top of the Mods to Install column — this is the **merge step** that combines everything into a single merged mod file.
4. Wait for **IMM_Merged_Mod_P** to appear under "*Icarus mods folder:*" on the right side — that's confirmation the merge succeeded.
5. Launch the game.

After the first time, the recurring weekly flow shrinks to the 3-click version covered earlier (Reload Last merged List → Install All Listed Mods → launch).

Where to go from here:

- **Single player** — that's it, you're done. The merged mod loads automatically when you launch Icarus.
- **Hosting on G-Portal or another server** — see the companion guide "*Installing Icarus Mods on a G-Portal Server*" for the upload steps.

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